Video game development relies on a specialized framework called the Game Development Life Cycle (GDLC), which adapts traditional software development for creative, multidisciplinary teams.

Major Phases of the GDLC

- **Initiation/Idea Generation:** Brainstorming core concepts, genre, target audience, and the overall vision.
- **Pre-Production:** Scoping work, building initial prototypes, writing scripts, and choosing a game engine.
- **Production:** Creating the actual assets, including programming mechanics, art, audio, and levels.
- **Testing (Alpha/Beta):** Running internal testing (Alpha) for bugs and external testing (Beta) for user experience and server stability.
- **Release/Deployment:** Publishing the finished game to platforms like PC, consoles, or mobile devices.
- **Post-Release/Maintenance:** Providing ongoing updates, downloadable content (DLC), and bug patches. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7] ← **Check the references for more information!**

Learn more about the core stages of creating a game in this overview of the development process:



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UEaeJlnnlsk